

Reading Skills

How can you differentiate between fact and opinion?

- India is an agricultural country.
- Nearly two-thirds of India's population depends directly on agriculture for its livelihood
- Indian farmers are the best in the world.
- Reduction of IIM fees by the government is a retrograde step.
- The government of India has reduced IIM fees.

Drawing inferences and conclusions

- An inference is a statement based on some situation, observations, facts, or specific details.
- Inference is the process of knowing the unknown from the known.
- Eg. In scientific experiments , the scientists draw inferences and conclusions based on observations.

Find the inference in the following passages

Passage 1: When an object is allowed to fall freely to the earth from some height, it accelerates as it falls. This acceleration is directed toward the centre of the earth, and its magnitude varies with the distance from the earth. However, if air is neglected, it has the same magnitude for all objects at any location. Near the surface of the earth, the acceleration due to gravity has a magnitude of 9.81 m/s^2 or 32.2 ft/s^2 . This implies that there is some net external force due to the attraction between the object and the earth.

Inference: passage 2

- We may find that it is easier to pull down than to pull up on a rope, and it may be easier to push rather than to pull objects. We also find it easier to do a certain amount of work by exerting small forces through large distances, rather than large forces through small distances. We can, therefore, perform certain tasks more easily in some ways than in others.

Class Activity

Answer the following questions after reading the paragraph.

- What is being implied, but not said directly?
- Are these inferences based on assumptions, data, or both?
- Could another interpretation exist?

Text from Article	What is Directly Stated?	What Can Be Inferred?	Evidence for Inference
<i>“Technophobia clouds an individual’s perception of the technology... making it appear somehow ‘not for them.’”</i>	Technophobia has the ability to distort someone’s views about technology.	People with technophobia may avoid technology even if it could help them.	The phrase “not for them” suggests self-exclusion despite potential benefits.
<i>“Technophobia remains just as relevant two decades on.”</i>	It hasn’t gone away with time.	Increasing tech availability alone hasn’t solved the issue.	Despite expectations in the 1980s, the problem persists today.